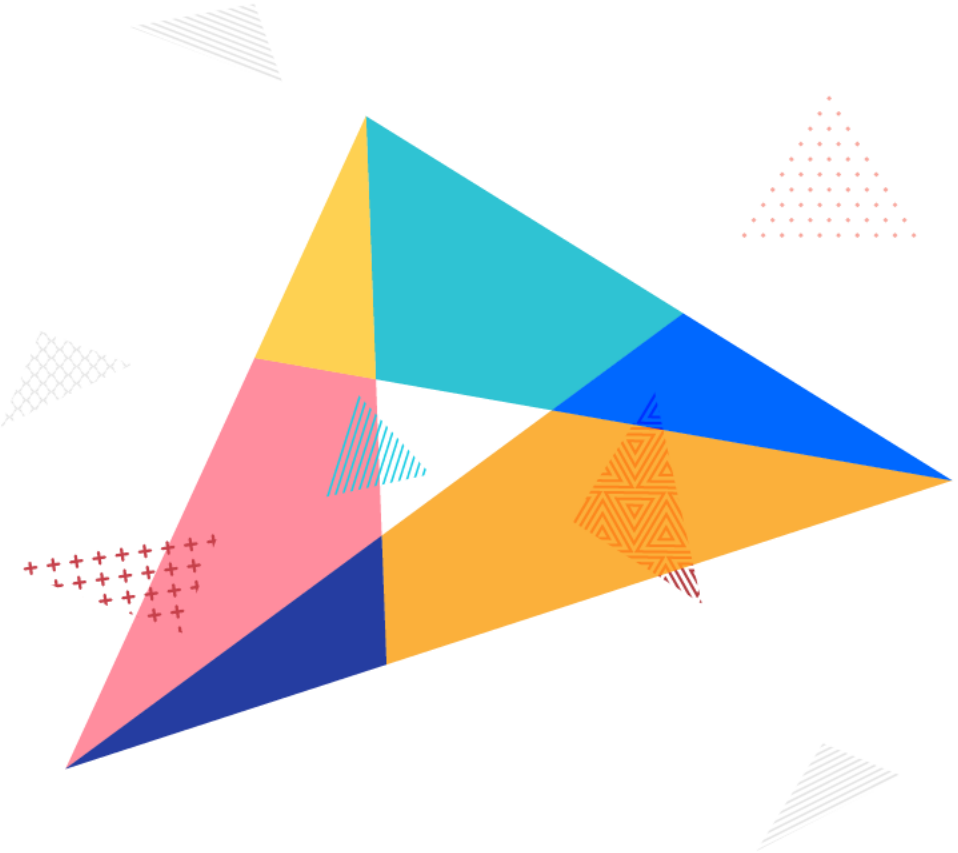
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RMIT University Vietnam, Saigon South Campus



Topic 2: Audit Mindset & Biases

Dr Thu Nguyen

Meet the Facilitator



Dr Thu Nguyen

Current role

Senior Program Manager and Lecturer in Entrepreneurship at RMIT University Vietnam

Qualifications

PhD in Management Sciences (France)
MA in Consultancy & Entrepreneurship (The Netherlands)

Experience

Over 20 years of combined industry and academic expertise

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At the end of this session, you will...

1. Catch your own biases
2. Own a 5-step routine to audit any judgment
3. Hear how bias leaks into what you say
4. Adapt one message to two very different audiences

Agenda

9:10	Activity 1: Estimation warm-up
9:30	Fast & slow thinking
9:45	Activity 2: Case Audit the Algorithm
10:20	Break
10:35	Activity 3: The Leak
10:55	Activity 4: The Influence Lab (optional)
11:40	Your Bias Audit Card

ACTIVITY 1A - WARM-UP

Give me a LOW and a HIGH

Two questions

Write both numbers on paper

Your range

LOW and HIGH, so you are 90% confident the truth sits inside.

No gaming

Don't play safe with an unreasonably wide range. Honest 90%.

WORKED EXAMPLE

“Height of Mount Everest?”

MY LOW: 7,000 m MY HIGH: 10,000 m

“I'm 90% sure the true height is inside that range.”

ACTIVITY 1A · THE QUESTIONS

Two questions about Zalo

A1 How many people worked at this company exactly five years ago?

A2 What percentage of our engineers joined in the last two years?

Write your LOW and your HIGH for each. 60 seconds.

Hands up if you are 90% confident the truth is inside your range.

AND NOW

Keep your hand up only if you'd bet 500,000₫ on your range.

ACTIVITY 1A · THE REVEAL

You claimed 90%.

A1

1097

"Hands up if your range contained it”

A2

18.82%

"Hands up if your range contained it”

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ACTIVITY 1B

Alex, a mid-level engineer

ON YOUR TABLE

One page. A promotion-readiness summary for a mid-level engineer on the payments platform team.

1. **Turn it over and read – alone**
   2 minutes. No discussion yet.

2. **Rate: how ready is Alex?**
   1 = not ready at all · 10 = fully ready now

3. **Give your rating number, then stop**
   Trust your first read. Don't revise it.

ACTIVITY 1B

Same engineer. Two ratings

▲

[X]

“top graduate of an elite CS programme”

●

[Y]

“hired after failing the first interview round”

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YOUR TABLE'S FLIP CHART

Start your bias map

What we just experienced	What it's called our name / research name	The System 1 shortcut behind it (optional)	Where it costs us at work

Fill two rows on the left now – the two things that just happened to you.

We'll add more later



25 x 14

MINI-INPUT · KAHNEMAN

Two systems, one brain

SYSTEM 1 – fast

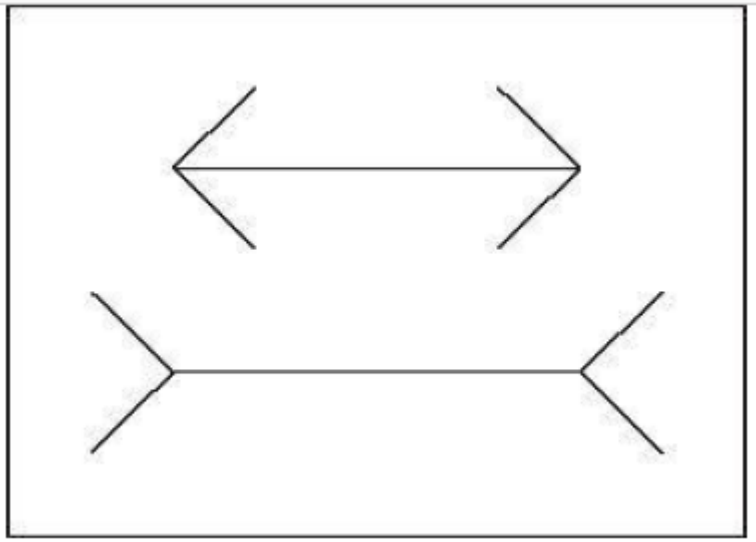
- Automatic, effortless, always on
- Runs on shortcuts and patterns
- Brilliant under routine – predictably wrong under pressure

↔

SYSTEM 2 – slow

- Deliberate, logical, effortful
- Lazy: engages only when summoned
- The system your routine will summon on purpose

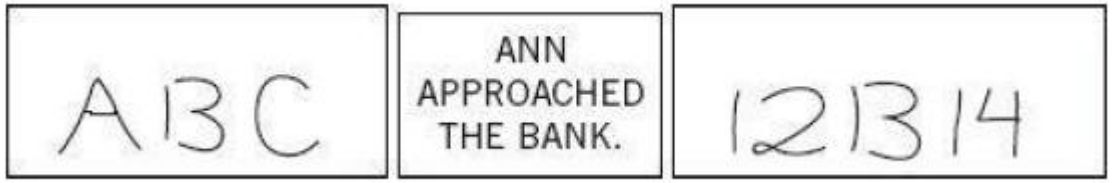
Bias is built-in, not character.



Answer in 30 second

A bat and ball cost $1.10.
The bat costs one dollar more than the ball.
How much does the ball cost?

All roses are flowers.
Some flowers fade quickly.
Therefore some roses fade quickly.



Note your bias on flip chart

THE ONE THAT MATTERS HERE

Expert bias

Over-trusting technical/expert judgment where it doesn't apply: reading people, weighing effort, judging who's underperforming.

IT SOUNDS LIKE

“If she were really trying, it would be done by now”

“It's faster if I do it myself.”

“I don't need to ask – I can see the quality isn't there .”

Bridging the Gap: The Audit Mindset

"**Concept:** You cannot eliminate System 1 reflexes. You can only learn to catch them."

Definition:
The Audit Mindset is the deliberate pause between a stimulus and your automatic reaction. It is the conscious activation of System 2 thinking.



The Goal:
Move from reacting to symptoms to diagnosing root causes.

FROM PROBLEM TO SOLUTION

Auditors can't remove bias either. So, they built a discipline.

- Questioning mind
- Suspension of judgment
- Search for evidence

Turned inward, it becomes a leadership tool:

THE AUDIT MINDSET

YOUR ROUTINE

The 5-Step Bias Self-Audit

1	**PAUSE**	Is this System 1 talking? What's my time pressure?
2	**EVIDENCE**	What supports my view? What would change my mind? Am I answering the question actually asked?
3	**OPPOSITE**	Argue the other side for 60 seconds.
4	**OUTSIDE VIEW**	What would a neutral colleague say?
5	**DECIDE & LOG**	Make the call; note your weak assumption.

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ACTIVITY 2 · TABLE GROUPS

Audit the Algorithm

THE DECISION

Priya, Product Engineer.

Your AI assistant drafted her review – and recommends moving the critical Q4 module off her, to a senior engineer or to you, to protect the deadline.

Confidence: HIGH

1

4 min · alone

Read it. Privately rate: how likely are you to move this work off Priya?

2

13 min · table discussion

Run the 5-step routine on the recommendation. Audit it like an auditor audits accounts.

Note your table average rate before discussion

3

4 min · re-rate

Rate again.

Post your table's before/after on the flip chart.

DEBRIEF

Four flaws

Visible ≠ valuable

Slack counts and ticket rank stood in for performance.

recency · availability

One voice, echoed

One reviewer, quoted once – replayed into “a well-established pattern”.

single-source confirmation

The invisible leave

Jan–Apr “zero contribution” was a maternity leave. Not in the AI's data.

data artifact

Fluent ≠ right

“Confidence: HIGH” and decisive prose recruit System 1 trust.

automation bias

THE QUESTION UNDERNEATH

Suppose you reassign.
Priya keeps her job. The deadline is protected.
Nobody complains.

What did it cost – and when does that cost appear?

An unaudited judgment delivered with great conversation technique is still an unfair conversation.



Take a 15-Minute Break

Back at 11:00

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ACTIVITY 3 · TABLES, THEN PAIRS

The Leak

Bias doesn't stay in your head. It leaks into what you say, what you leave unsaid, and who you ask.

8 min · table

Lines managers say.
Which bias produced it? What does the listener hear? Mark the two you hear most here.

5 min · table

Rewrite your two – same standard, same honesty, without the bias.

7 min · pairs

One sentence you actually said last month. Read it aloud. Your partner offers one rewrite.

Nothing leaves your pair unless you choose to share it.

THE LEAK · THE SIX LINES

Which of these do you hear here?

1. “Just send it to me, I'll fix it quickly.”
2. “I already know what the problem is – we just need to execute.”
3. “Let me review it before it goes out.” (every time, forever)
4. “She goes quiet in meetings – she’s probably not confident.”
5. “Business never understands technical constraints.”
6. “It's faster if I do it myself.”

	The line	The bias underneath	What the listener hears	A rewrite that keeps the standard
1	*"Just send it to me, I'll fix it quickly"*	Expert bias (quality-standard drift)	"My work isn't good enough and I won't get better"	*"Walk me through your approach - I'll flag the two riskiest parts and you fix them"*
2	*"I already know what the problem is - we just need to execute"*	Confirmation bias (jumping to how before what / why)	"Don't bring me evidence. Don't tell me I'm solving the wrong problem"	*"Here's my hypothesis. What would prove me wrong?"*
3	*"Let me review it before it goes out" (every time)"*	Control of how rather than management of outputs	"I am not trusted, and I never will be"	*"Here's what 'done well' means for this. I'll review exceptions, not everything."*
4	*"She goes quiet in meetings, she's probably not confident"*	Fundamental attribution error (single-signal reading)	(She never hears it; and that's the problem)	*"I've noticed you're quiet in design reviews; what makes it easier or harder to jump in?"*
5	*"Business never understands technical constraints"*	Out-group stereotyping/curse of knowledge	"This manager has already decided we're the obstacle"	*"What does Business measure? Which of our constraints changes their number?"*
6	*"It's faster if I do it myself"*	Self-serving attribution/short-horizon bias	"My growth is not part of the plan"	*"It's faster this once. What does it cost me by Q4, and who should own this by then?"*

THE LEAK · DEBRIEF

Bias doesn't stay private.

Your listener never hears the judgment – only the sentence.

As a technical expert, your judgment was the product.

As a manager, your judgment is an input – what you say is the product.

MINI-INPUT

Tactics fit the audience – and the direction

Rational persuasion, consultation and inspirational appeals beat pressure.
Upward ≠ downward ≠ lateral.

Yukl & Tracey, 1992

Trust = Ability · Benevolence · Integrity

Credibility is granted by the audience, never assumed. Audit it per relationship.

Mayer, Davis & Schoorman, 1995

The bias to beat: "what convinces me will convince them."

CLOSING

Your Bias Audit Card

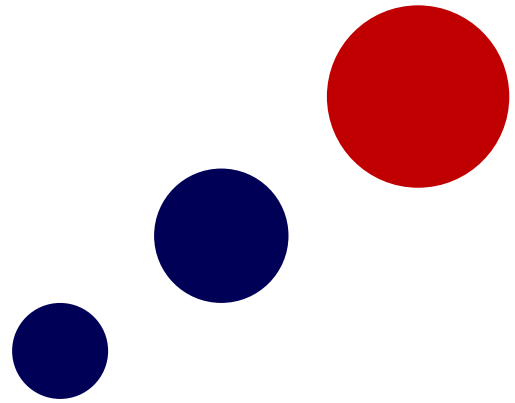
1. **My expert bias** — from our table's bias map, the one that costs me most
2. **My audit trigger** — where I'll run the 5-step routine
3. **My leaked line** — the sentence I'll stop saying – and what I'll say instead
4. **Into this afternoon** — the bias to keep out of my next performance conversation

CLOSE · 10 MINUTES/INDIVIDUAL

You were promoted because your judgment was better than most people's.
This morning asked you to audit it – before it becomes a decision about someone else, and before it becomes a sentence you can't take back.

"You've audited the judgment.

This afternoon, you practise the conversation."



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Thank you!

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